www.tntextbooks.in

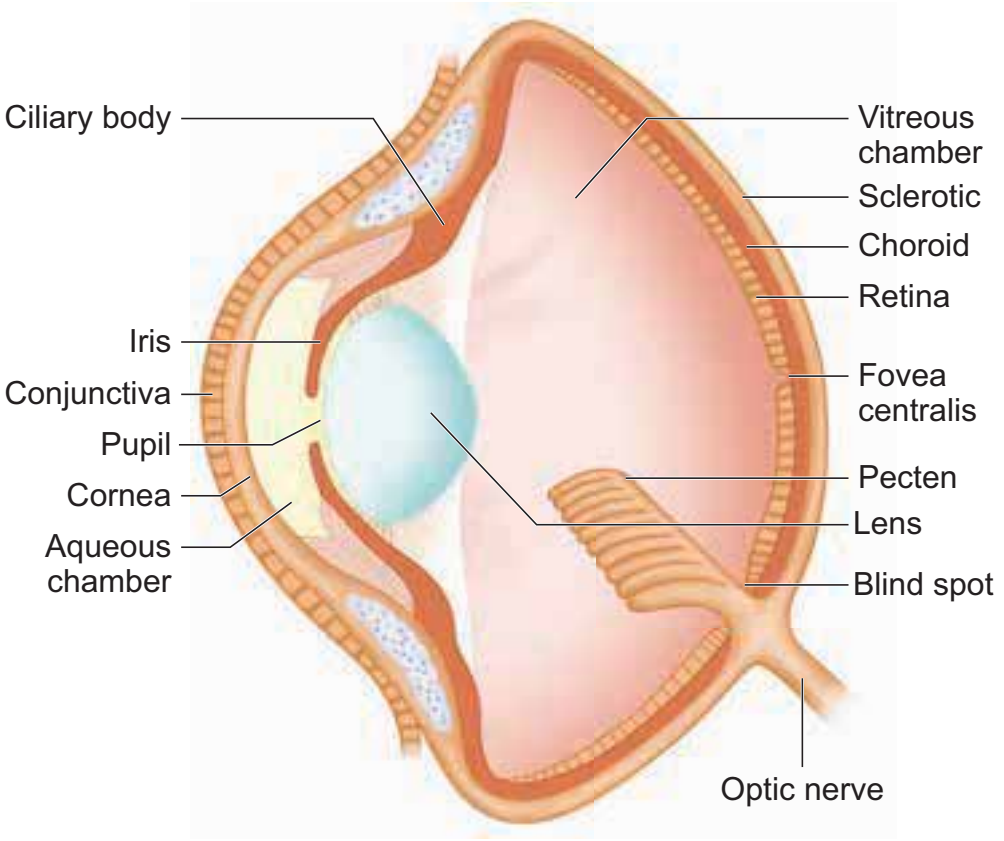

Figure 4.35 Pigeon – Eye in Vertical Section (VS)

The cerebellum extends backwards covering a large part of the medulla oblongata which descends downwards to join the **spinal cord.** The medulla oblongata controls the involuntary movement. The olfactory lobes or bulbs are small and degenerate due to poorly developed organs of smell.

The peripheral nervous system consists of 12 pairs of **cranial nerves** and 38 pairs of **spinal nerves**. The autonomic nervous system of pigeon includes the **sympathetic** and **parasympathetic** nervous system. It contains the nerves and ganglia. The sympathetic nerves supply the alimentary, respiratory, circulatory and urinogenital systems.

In Pigeon what part of its brain will you relate with its remarkable ability to discriminate between cancerous and non cancerous images ?

Sense organs

Eyes are large and well developed; they are not spherical, but biconvex. The sclerotic coat contains bony plates. There is a vascular pigmented plaited process known as the **pecten,** projecting into the **vitreous body** from the point where the optic nerve enters the eye (Figure 4.35). Pecten is concerned with the power of accommodation which is greatly developed in birds. The muscles for the movement of the eye-balls are reduced. In the **ear,** the **cochlea** is well developed. The two **eustachian tubes** unite and open by a common aperture on the roof of the buccal cavity. The **olfactory** sense is poorly developed.